

August 18, 2025

Office of United States Trade Representative
600 17th Street, N.W.
Washington, D.C. 20508

Re: Request to Testify at Public Hearing, Initiation of Section 301 Investigation of Brazil (Docket No. USTR-2025-0043)

On behalf of the National Pork Producers Council (NPPC), I request a representative appear at the September 3, 2025, public hearing for Docket No. USTR-2025-0043 on the Section 301 Investigation of Acts, Policies, and Practices of Brazil Related to Digital Trade and Electronic Payment Services; Unfair, Preferential Tariffs; Anti-Corruption Enforcement; Intellectual Property Protection; Ethanol Market Access; and Illegal Deforestation. We seek to have Ms. Maria C. Zieba, Vice President of Government Affairs testify on behalf of NPPC.

Testimony will align with our written comments submitted on August 18, 2025, a summary of which follows:

NPPC is a national association representing the federal public policy and global interests of more than 60,000 U.S. pork producers. The U.S. pork industry is a major value-added sector in the agricultural economy and a significant contributor to the overall U.S. economy. More than 500,000 American jobs are supported by U.S. pork production with U.S. pork exports accounting for more than 70,000 of these jobs.

The United States is among the top global exporters of pork, shipping more than 3 million metric tons (MT), valued in 2024 at \$8.63 billion, to more than 100 countries annually. Gaining and expanding access to markets around the world is paramount to the growth of the U.S. pork industry. NPPC supports efforts to expand U.S. trade and market access opportunities and ensure that U.S. agricultural exports, such as pork, are not subject to unfair tariffs or non-tariff barriers, such as those imposed by Brazil.

While U.S. pork has been shut out of the Brazilian market, Brazilian producers have enjoyed access to the United States. Over the past decade, Brazilian pork exports have increased by over 1,900%. In 2014, the United States imported \$5.2 million of pork and pork products from Brazil, and the total has grown to over \$104 million in 2024.

Unfortunately, Brazil has a de facto ban on U.S. pork that stymies any access for reasons that lack any scientific justification. NPPC requests that USTR works to eliminate such baseless, non-tariff barriers, imposed under the guise of food safety, so that fresh, frozen, and processed U.S. pork may be shipped to Latin America's largest economy.

Specifically, Brazil continues to flout international commitments of the World Trade Organization's (WTO) Sanitary and Phytosanitary (SPS) Agreement to not impose more stringent requirements on imported product than those imposed on domestic products to achieve an "appropriate level of protection" to ensure animal health and food safety. The United States animal health inspection and food safety standards and systems ensure animal and public health are among the most robust of any country. The United States, one of the largest exporters of pork in the world, operates a world-class plant inspection and approval system and is more capable than any other country of meeting Brazil's "appropriate level of protection" standards for imported pork. Brazil's failure to recognize the U.S. system and insistence on plant-by-plant approvals are unacceptable barriers to U.S. pork access.

We appreciate consideration of our request to testify at the September public hearing on Docket No. USTR-2025-0043 and look forward to the opportunity to further detail our views on the initiation of Section 301 investigation of Brazil.

Sincerely,



Maria C. Zieba
Vice President of Government Affairs